Coaching Codex



COACHING CODEX · GUIDE 15 · AI IMAGE & VIDEO CREATION

Make Scroll-Stopping Graphics with AI

Create on-brand posts, banners and carousels without a designer: a one-page brand kit, image prompts that work, and ten reusable designs you check.

1	7	10
page brand kit from your own facts	part image prompt formula	reusable designs to fill in

START HERE

On-brand graphics without a designer

You do not need design training to make posts, banners and carousels that look like they belong to one business. This guide gives you a one-page brand kit, an image prompt formula that keeps AI on track, and ten reusable designs you fill in each week. AI suggests images and words; you check every fact before anything goes out.

Kit

One page

Your colors, fonts, logo rules and voice, written down once.

Prompt

7 parts

An image prompt formula that asks for what you need and rules out what you don't.

Reuse

10 designs

Templates you fill in with new facts instead of starting from a blank canvas.

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YOUR FACTS IN, A DESIGN OUT

AI is good at backgrounds, layouts and short headlines. It is bad at knowing your prices, dates and products. Every prompt here gives AI your confirmed facts, tells it not to invent anything and asks it to check with you when something is missing.

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SECTION 01 · THE BASICS

What makes a graphic stop the scroll

People scroll fast. A graphic earns a second look when it has one clear message, big readable words, strong contrast and colors people start to recognize as yours. Fancy effects matter far less than consistency.

Plain post	Designed post
A long sentence typed over a busy photo	One short headline with space around it
New colors and fonts every time	The same 2–3 brand colors and 2 fonts
Small text that is hard to read on a phone	Large text, high contrast, readable at a glance
No clear next step	One action: visit, book, reply, save

The one-line rule

AI makes the background and the first draft of the words; you supply the facts, the product photos and the final check. Real products, real people and real results always come from you, never from an image generator.

PROMPT · REVIEW MY CURRENT POSTS

Here are descriptions of my last **[NUMBER]** social posts: **[DESCRIBE EACH: COLORS, FONTS, TEXT, PHOTO OR NOT]**.
My business: **[ONE SENTENCE]**.
For each post, tell me whether the message is clear in one glance, and list what is inconsistent between posts (colors, fonts, tone). Use only what I described. Do not guess results or engagement. If a description is unclear, ask me first.

EXERCISE 1 · YOUR THREE MOST COMMON POSTS (3 MINUTES)

Write the three kinds of graphic you make most often (for example: a weekly offer, a tip, an event announcement).

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SECTION 02 · BRAND KIT

Brand kit basics: colors, fonts, logo, voice

A brand kit is one page that answers: which colors, which fonts, where the logo goes and how we sound. Write it once and paste it into every design prompt.

Part	What to decide	Example (fictional)
Colors	1 main, 1 background, 1 accent, with hex codes	Forest green #2F4A3A · Cream #F4EBDD · Copper #B87333
Fonts	1 headline font, 1 body font	Playfair Display (headlines) · Lato (body)
Logo	Which version, where, minimum size	Cream logo, bottom right corner
Photo style	Light, mood, what to show	Natural daylight, wood and linen, calm
Voice	3 words, plus words you never use	Warm, simple, local · never "cheap"

PROMPT · TURN MY NOTES INTO A BRAND KIT

Organize these facts into a one-page brand kit with sections: colors, fonts, logo rules, photo style, voice.
My colors (with hex codes if I have them): **[COLORS]**
My fonts: **[FONTS OR "NOT CHOSEN YET"]**
My logo versions: **[LOGO FILES I HAVE]**
Words that describe my business: **[3 WORDS]**
Use only these facts. Do not invent hex codes, font names or rules. Where something is missing, write **[TO DECIDE]** and ask me one question about it.

FINDING YOUR HEX CODES

If you already have a logo, a template tool's color picker can show the exact hex code of each color. Copy the codes into your kit rather than asking AI to guess them from a description.

EXERCISE 2 · FILL IN YOUR KIT

Write your three colors and two fonts. If you have not chosen fonts yet, pick one bold headline font and one plain body font in your template tool.

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SECTION 03 · TOOLS

Pick your tools: AI images and templates

You need two kinds of tool: something that makes images or backgrounds, and a template tool where you add your text, logo and photos. Many tools now do both. Features and plans change often, so check what you already have before paying for anything.

Tool type	Examples	Good for	Check first
Chat assistant with images	ChatGPT, Gemini, Microsoft Copilot	Backgrounds, scenes, ideas, headline drafts	Whether your plan includes image creation
Design template tool	Canva, Adobe Express	Brand colors, fonts, logo, text, resizing	Which AI features your plan includes
Built-in image generators	Canva's AI image tools, Adobe Firefly	Images made inside your design	Each tool's terms for commercial use

1. Use the image tool for backgrounds, textures and scenes only.
2. Add your headline, offer, logo and real product photo in the template tool.
3. Save the result as a template so next week you only change the words.

RIGHTS AND PRIVACY

Read each tool's current terms on commercial use before you post AI images for your business. Do not upload photos of customers or staff without their permission, and do not ask for images in the style of a living artist or with another brand's logo or characters. If you sell in the UK or EU, photos of people can be personal data under GDPR.

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SECTION 04 · IMAGE PROMPTS

The 7-part image prompt formula

Vague prompts give random pictures. Describe seven things and the results get much more predictable. Leave out any part you do not care about, but always include Format and Avoid.

Part	Ask yourself	Example (fictional)
1 · Subject	What is in the picture?	Fresh figs and a cedar sprig
2 · Setting	Where is it?	On a dark wooden tabletop
3 · Style	Photo, flat illustration, 3D, watercolor?	Natural photo, soft daylight
4 · Colors	Which brand colors lead?	Forest green and cream, copper accents
5 · Composition	Where must space stay empty?	Empty center for our product photo
6 · Format	Which shape?	4:5 vertical (feed post)
7 · Avoid	What must not appear?	No text, letters, logos, people or hands

PROMPT · IMAGE PROMPT TEMPLATE

Create an image for a **[POST TYPE]** for my business.
Subject: **[SUBJECT]**. Setting: **[SETTING]**. Style: **[STYLE]**.
Colors: **[BRAND COLORS WITH HEX CODES]**. Composition: **[WHERE TO LEAVE EMPTY SPACE]**.
Format: **[1:1 / 4:5 / 9:16 / 16:9]**.
Avoid: text, letters, logos, real brands, recognizable people, **[ANYTHING ELSE]**.
This is a background only. I will add my own text, logo and product photo.

WHY "NO TEXT" MATTERS

Image generators can misspell or distort words. Ask for a clean background, then type your headline in the template tool, where you control the spelling, font and size.

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SECTION 05 · TRUST

What never to fake with AI images

An AI image that looks like your product, your shop or your customer is a promise. If the real thing looks different, people notice, and trust is hard to win back. Use AI for mood and backgrounds, and real photos for anything a customer will buy, visit or rely on.

Fine to make with AI	Use real photos or nothing
Backgrounds, textures, patterns	Your actual products, food, rooms or work
Simple illustrations and icons	Before/after results and transformations
Seasonal scenes and mood images	Customers, staff, reviews and testimonials
Abstract shapes for text slides	Awards, certificates, logos of partners

PROMPT · IS THIS IMAGE HONEST?

I plan to post this image: **[DESCRIBE THE IMAGE]**.
With this text: **[YOUR HEADLINE AND CAPTION]**.
The real product or service looks like this: **[DESCRIBE THE REAL THING]**.
List anything in the image or text that a customer could take as a promise about the real product, price, result or people that my description does not support. Do not judge the design. If you need more detail about the real product, ask me first.

LABEL WHEN IT MATTERS

Some platforms ask you to label realistic AI-generated or edited images, and their rules change. Check the current rules of each platform you post on. When an image could be mistaken for a real photo of your business, add a short note such as "AI-generated background".

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SECTION 06 · TEMPLATES

Templates and carousels in Canva or Adobe Express

The fastest way to stay on brand is to stop designing from scratch. Build each design once with your kit, save it as a template, and next time change only the words and the photo.

1. Add your colors, fonts and logo to the tool's brand settings if your plan has them; otherwise keep your kit page open.
2. Pick a layout in the right shape (4:5 or 1:1 for feed, 9:16 for stories).
3. Swap in your colors and fonts, place your logo, and leave one big area for the headline.
4. Drop in your AI background or real photo.
5. Duplicate the design and rename it, for example "Tip card template".

PROMPT · PLAN A 5-SLIDE CAROUSEL

Plan a **[NUMBER]**-slide carousel for **[PLATFORM]** from these facts:
Topic: **[TOPIC]**. Reader: **[WHO IT IS FOR]**.
My confirmed facts or tips: **[PASTE FACTS]**
Call to action: **[WHAT THE READER SHOULD DO]**.
For each slide give: a headline under 8 words, one supporting line under 15 words, and a background idea. Slide 1 is the hook; the last slide is the call to action. Use only my facts. Do not invent numbers, prices, dates or results. If I have not given enough facts for every slide, ask me first.

EXERCISE 3 · YOUR FIRST TEMPLATE

Which of your three common posts from Exercise 1 will you turn into a template first? Which shape does it need?

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SECTION 07 · VERIFY

Check and repair every design

A good-looking graphic can still carry a wrong date or a promise you never made. Spend two minutes on every design before posting, checking against your records and your brand kit, not against the AI's opinion.

- [ ] Every date, price, offer and name matches your records
- [ ] Headline is spelled correctly and readable on a phone screen
- [ ] Colors and fonts match your brand kit (check the hex codes)
- [ ] Products, people and results shown are real, or clearly not your product
- [ ] Logo is in the agreed place, and no other brand's logo appears

PROMPT · FIND WHAT I DIDN'T GIVE YOU

Here are my confirmed facts: **[PASTE FACTS]**
Here is the text on my graphic and caption: **[PASTE TEXT]**
List every date, number, name, offer and claim in the text. Mark each FROM MY FACTS or NOT IN MY FACTS. Then rewrite the text removing everything marked NOT IN MY FACTS. Do not add anything new.

Check	Pass?	Note
Facts match my records		
Text readable on a phone		
Brand colors and fonts used		
No fake product, people or results		

REPAIR PHRASES THAT WORK

For text: **Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else.**
For images: **Keep everything the same, but remove [ITEM] and leave that area empty.**

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SECTION 08 · REUSE

Your 10 reusable designs

Build these once as templates. Each week, pick one or two, paste in new confirmed facts and post.

#	Design	What you change each time	Image source
1	Tip card	One tip, one line of explanation	AI texture or plain brand color
2	Announcement	What is new, when, where	AI background + real product photo
3	Offer or event banner	Confirmed offer, dates, how to join	AI background
4	FAQ card	One real customer question and your answer	Plain brand color
5	Quote card	A quote you have permission to use	Plain brand color
6	Behind the scenes	One sentence about your process	Your real photo
7	Carousel cover	Hook headline for a 5-slide carousel	AI background
8	Carousel slide	Headline and one supporting line	Same background as cover
9	Story call to action	One action and the link or place	AI background
10	Seasonal greeting	Season, opening hours if they change	AI seasonal scene

PROMPT · FILL A TEMPLATE WITH THIS WEEK'S FACTS

Template: **[DESIGN NAME FROM THE LIST]**. Brand voice: **[3 WORDS]**.
This week's confirmed facts: **[FACTS]**.
Write a headline under 8 words, a supporting line under 15 words and a call to action under 6 words. Use only these facts. If a fact the template needs is missing, ask me instead of guessing.

- [ ] My brand kit is saved where I can paste it
- [ ] Every graphic was checked against my facts before posting
- [ ] No AI image shows a product, person or result that is not real

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FIRST WIN · FICTIONAL EXAMPLE

Your first win, start to finish

Walk through one feed post for a made-up two-person candle shop in Portland, Oregon. Nothing here is a real business, real people or live AI output.

Example input	Value
Business	Hollow Oak Candle Co. (fictional), Portland, Oregon; two owners
Brand kit	Forest green #2F4A3A · cream #F4EBDD · copper #B87333 · Playfair Display + Lato · voice: warm, simple, local
Post	Instagram feed post, 4:5 vertical; real product photo goes in the middle
Confirmed facts	New scent: Cedar & Fig · scent notes: cedarwood and fig · hand-poured in our Portland workshop · in store and online from Saturday

EXAMPLE COMPLETED PROMPT

Plan one Instagram feed post (4:5 vertical) for my candle shop (fictional example for practice).

Brand kit:
Colors: forest green #2F4A3A, cream #F4EBDD, copper #B87333
Fonts: Playfair Display (headlines), Lato (body)
Voice: warm, simple, local
Confirmed facts:
New scent: Cedar & Fig
Scent notes: cedarwood and fig
Hand-poured in our Portland workshop
Available in store and online from Saturday

Give me: (1) an image prompt for a background only, using subject, setting, style, colors, composition, format and avoid, with the center left empty for my real product photo and no text, logos, people or candles; (2) a headline under 6 words; (3) one supporting line under 12 words; (4) a call to action under 8 words. Use only these facts. Do not invent prices, discounts, dates, ingredients or claims. If an essential fact is missing, ask me before answering.

Copy it, open your AI assistant (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or Copilot), paste and send. Then compare what you get with this:

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

Image prompt: Fresh figs and a cedar sprig at the edges of a dark wooden tabletop, natural photo in soft daylight, forest green (#2F4A3A) and cream (#F4EBDD) tones with copper (#B87333) accents, empty center for a product photo, 4:5 vertical. Avoid: text, letters, logos, people, hands, candles.
Headline: New scent: Cedar & Fig
Supporting line: Cedarwood and fig, hand-poured in Portland.
Call to action: In store and online from Saturday.

Checks before use

- [ ] The image prompt asks for a background only: no candle is drawn, so the real product photo shows the real product.
- [ ] All three hex codes match the brand kit exactly.
- [ ] Every word of text comes from the facts: scent name, notes, Portland workshop, Saturday.
- [ ] Nothing was added: no price, discount, burn time or other claim.

USE IT

Make the background in your image tool, then place it, your real product photo, the checked text and your logo in your template tool yourself. The webpage does not create or post anything.

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GUIDED TASK

Write your one-page brand kit

When to use it: Once, before you make your next graphic. Update it when your look changes. **Prepare:** Your logo files; Your colors (hex codes if you have them); Fonts you already use, if any.

Question	Example answer
What are your brand colors?	Forest green #2F4A3A, cream #F4EBDD, copper #B87333
Which fonts do you use?	Playfair Display for headlines, Lato for body text
Which logo versions do you have?	Green logo on cream; cream logo for dark backgrounds
Three words that describe how you sound.	Warm, simple, local
Describe your business in one sentence.	A two-person candle shop in Portland, Oregon
Which language should the text be in?	English

PROMPT TEMPLATE

About my business: [ABOUT YOUR BUSINESS]
Organize these facts into a one-page brand kit with sections: colors, fonts, logo rules, photo style, voice.
My colors: [COLORS]
My fonts: [FONTS]
My logo versions: [LOGO VERSIONS]
My voice: [3 WORDS]
Language: [LANGUAGE].

Use only these facts. Do not invent hex codes, font names or rules. Where something is missing, write [TO DECIDE] and ask me one question about it.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

Colors: main forest green #2F4A3A, background cream #F4EBDD, accent copper #B87333 · Fonts: Playfair Display (headlines), Lato (body) · Logo: green on cream backgrounds, cream on dark backgrounds; placement [TO DECIDE] · Photo style: [TO DECIDE] · Voice: warm, simple, local. Question: where should the logo usually go on your posts?

Checks before use

- [ ] Every hex code matches what you entered, character by character.
- [ ] Font names are the ones you gave, spelled correctly.
- [ ] Gaps are marked [TO DECIDE], not filled with guesses.
- [ ] You answered the AI's questions yourself.

Repairs

If...	Send this
Invented or changed a fact	"Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else."
Invented a color or font	"Remove "[ITEM]". I did not choose it. Mark it [TO DECIDE]. Change nothing else."
Too long	"Fit the kit on one page: one line per section. Keep every fact exactly as written."

Next action: Save the checked kit where you can paste it, and add the colors and fonts to your template tool.

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GUIDED TASK

Write an image prompt for a background

When to use it: You need a background, texture or scene for a post, banner or story. **Prepare:** Your brand colors; The shape you need (1:1, 4:5, 9:16, 16:9); Where your text and photo will go.

Question	Example answer
What is the graphic for?	An Instagram feed post announcing a new scent
What should be in the picture, and where?	Fresh figs and a cedar sprig on a dark wooden tabletop
Which style?	Natural photo, soft daylight
Which brand colors should lead?	Forest green #2F4A3A and cream #F4EBDD, copper #B87333 accents
Where must space stay empty?	Empty center for my product photo
Which shape?	4:5 vertical

PROMPT TEMPLATE

Create an image for **[POST TYPE]**.
Subject and setting: **[SUBJECT AND SETTING]**. Style: **[STYLE]**.
Colors: **[BRAND COLORS]**. Composition: **[EMPTY SPACE]**.
Format: **[FORMAT]**.
Avoid: text, letters, logos, real brands, recognizable people.
This is a background only. I will add my own text, logo and product photo. If anything here is unclear, ask me before creating the image.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

(Image) A dark wooden tabletop with figs and a cedar sprig near the edges, soft daylight, green and cream tones with copper accents, a clear empty area in the center, vertical 4:5, no text or logos.

Checks before use

- [ ] The center (or your chosen area) is really empty.
- [ ] No text, letters, logos or people appear anywhere, even blurred.
- [ ] Colors are close to your kit; fix exact colors in the template tool.
- [ ] Nothing in the image could be mistaken for your real product.

Repairs

If...	Send this
Added something you ruled out	"Keep everything the same, but remove [ITEM] and leave that area empty."
Wrong shape	"Recreate the same image in [FORMAT]. Change nothing else."
Too busy	"Keep the same subject, but use fewer objects and more empty background. Change nothing else."

Next action: Download the image, place it in your template and add your real photo, text and logo yourself.

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GUIDED TASK

Plan a 5-slide carousel from your facts

When to use it: You have a few tips or facts that would work better as swipeable slides than one image. **Prepare:** 3–5 confirmed tips or facts; Who the carousel is for; One action you want readers to take.

Question	Example answer
What is the carousel about?	How to make a candle burn evenly
Who is it for?	Customers who just bought their first candle from us
Paste your confirmed tips or facts.	First burn: let the wax melt to the edges · Trim the wick before each burn · Keep away from drafts
What should readers do at the end?	Save this post for your next candle
Which platform?	Instagram
Which language should the text be in?	English

PROMPT TEMPLATE

Plan a 5-slide carousel for [PLATFORM].
Topic: [TOPIC]. Reader: [READER].
My confirmed facts:
[YOUR FACTS]
Call to action: [CALL TO ACTION]. Language: [LANGUAGE].

For each slide give a headline under 8 words, one supporting line under 15 words and a background idea. Slide 1 is the hook; slide 5 is the call to action. Use only my facts. Do not invent numbers, times, prices or results. If I have not given enough facts for every slide, ask me before planning.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

1 · Get an even burn every time (cream background) · 2 · First burn: melt to the edges (warm close-up texture) · 3 · Trim the wick first (plain green) · 4 · Keep it away from drafts (soft window light) · 5 · Save this for your next candle (brand colors, logo).

Checks before use

- [ ] Each tip comes from your facts, with nothing added.
- [ ] No burn times, numbers or safety claims you did not give.
- [ ] Slide 1 is a hook and the last slide is your call to action.
- [ ] Headlines are short enough to read on a phone.

Repairs

If...	Send this
Invented or changed a fact	"Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else."
Added a tip you did not give	"Remove "[TIP]". It is not one of my facts. Change nothing else."
Headlines too long	"Shorten every headline to under 6 words. Keep the meaning and facts the same."

Next action: Build the slides from your carousel template, check them once more, and post them yourself.

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WHAT'S NEXT

One kit. One formula. Ten designs you reuse every week.

Write your brand kit once, prompt for clean backgrounds, add your own facts and photos in a template, and check every design before it goes out. That is how you look consistent without a designer.

Write a Week of Social Media Posts in 30 Minutes with AI

Plan the captions that go with your new graphics.

Turn One Video into 10 Posts: AI Content Repurposing

Turn one video into posts, quotes and carousel slides.

AI for Local Marketing: Google Business Profile, Reviews & Local Posts

Use your graphics in local posts and offers.

50 Copy-Paste AI Prompts for Small Business Owners

Fifty ready prompts for marketing, sales, service, admin and planning.

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